

G A M 7 0 8

Major Project

Module Induction · 2025–26



Who am I?

Dr William Huber

Associate Professor of Game Development
Module Leader, GAM708

- PhD in Art and Media History
- Research in videogames, new media, and digital culture
- Interested in ambitious, conceptually driven projects that don't fit neatly into a box

william.huber@falmouth.ac.uk

falmouth.ac.uk/staff/dr-william-huber

Module Leader & Supervisors

MODULE LEADER

William Huber

Videogames, new media, digital culture

DESIGN

Jeff Howard

Quest design, game magic, Gothic themes

DESIGN

Tony Pellicone

Game-based learning, player experience

COMP

Anjuman Shaheen

Game programming, reflective game design

AI

Daniel Zhang

Machine learning, AI systems for games

ART

Phoebe Herring

Game art, digital portfolios

ART

Ady Smith

Game art; industry background (Rare, EA)

ART

Lee Walton

3D art, industry pipeline

ART

William Pryn

Veteran 3D artist; environment & character

Outlining the

Major Project

The module in brief

- 60 credits — roughly double the workload of your previous modules (approximately 600 hours)
- A major research and development project within an area of specialism pertinent to your interests
- You define the question. You choose the methodology. You build the thing.
- **"Fully realised, polished, and of publishable quality" — this is what Masters-level output means**
- Your supervisor mentors you through it — but independence is yours and expected

Module Timeline



Your Supervisor

- **Your supervisor is a mentor, not a project manager**
- Allocated via the timetabling process — you will hear about this shortly

What your supervisor provides:

- Advice on practice and approach
- Guidance on research methods and framing
- Feedback on work-in-progress at timetabled supervision meetings

What the independence is yours to provide:

- Defining the question
- Doing the work
- Showing up prepared to your supervision meetings
- For escalations, module queries, or anything that can't be resolved with your supervisor:
william.huber@falmouth.ac.uk

Completing Your

Assessment

Two Assessments — Both Compulsory

Project Proposal

20%

- 10-min presentation
- Proposal Form submitted to Learning Space
- Assesses LOs 1 (Advocate) & 4 (Present)

Major Project Artefact

80%

- Artefact .zip + process documentation
- 10-min reflective video
- Assesses LOs 2 (Research), 3 (Reflect) & 5 (Innovate)

The Proposal (20%)

Part A — Presentation

- 10 minutes + Q&A
- Present on Tuesday 24 June (online)
- Seven questions to address:
 - Context and field
 - State of the art and key literature
 - Research questions
 - Artefact format and audience
 - Legal, social, ethical issues

Part B — Proposal Form

- Submit to Learning Space at time of presentation
- Covers: research question, artefact format, methodology, ethics, project plan, process documentation method

Process documentation method must be identified in your proposal and confirmed by your supervisor via written feedback

The Artefact (80%)

Part A — Artefact Submission

- Upload .zip to Learning Space (max 1GB)
- Include or link your process documentation
- Deadline: 1–2 September

Part B — Reflective Video

- 10 minutes (standard)
- Upload alongside your artefact
- Addresses 6 reflective questions
- Contextualises your work — informs feedback but is not separately graded

The artefact is the primary object of assessment

No live viva — written feedback returned within 15 working days

What you might make

Software product

Game, app, tool, prototype — marketable or demo

Portfolio of creative work

Coherent body of art or design, professionally presented

Written dissertation

Long-form scholarly argument; contribution to knowledge

Anything else

LARP, installation, escape room, streaming format, board game, AI system... discuss with your supervisor

Artefact-type submission requirements

Software products and games

- README with system requirements; include walkthrough or gameplay footage (~5 min) — especially where build distribution is unreliable

Written dissertations

- No additional video content required beyond the standard 10-min reflection

Portfolios of creative work

- Include walkthrough video (~5 min) guiding the assessor through the portfolio and key creative decisions

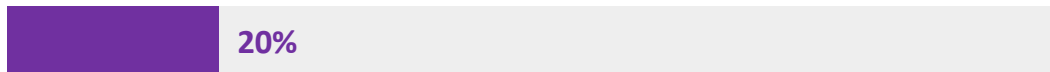
Other artefact types

- Discuss additional submission requirements with your supervisor at proposal stage

What good looks like — Artefact Rubric

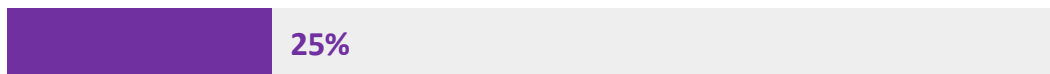
Research: state-of-the-art awareness

Engagement with the field — does your project know what it's responding to?



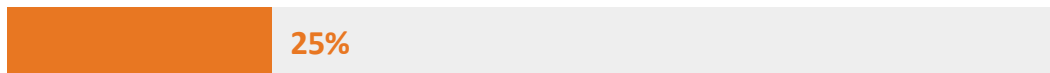
Research: methods, conventions & craft

Execution and finish — is the artefact well-made by the standards of the discipline?



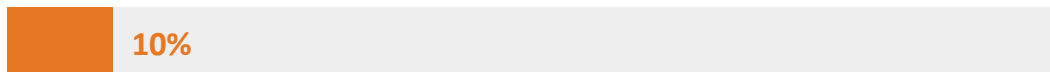
Innovate: originality and realisation

Creative problem-solving — is the innovation legible and credible in the work itself?



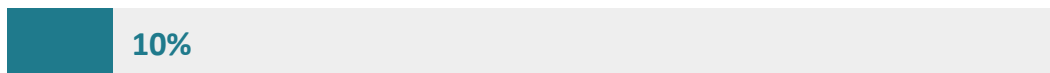
Innovate: leadership potential

Wider contribution — does the work have implications for the field?



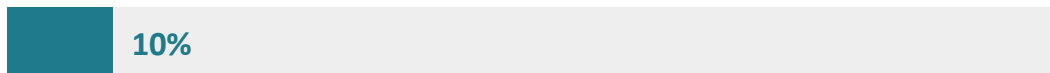
Reflect: professional aspirations

Alignment — does the project serve your career trajectory?



Reflect: process and self-reflection

Development — is there evidence your thinking evolved?



Process Documentation

What it is: a record of your development process — how your thinking changed

- You propose the form at proposal stage — your supervisor confirms it is appropriate
- It must be included in or linked from your artefact submission
- You should draw on it explicitly in your reflective video

What it might look like:

- Development blog or journal
- Git commit history with meaningful messages
- Sketchbook (scanned or photographed)
- Design portfolio with iteration documentation
- Annotated production journal

This provides the evidence that your assessor needs to understand how your work developed

Maintaining Good

Academic Conduct

Research Ethics

- **You must follow Falmouth University's Research Ethics Policy**
- Discuss ethics with your supervisor — address it explicitly in your proposal
- Ethics form submitted as part of your final artefact submission

Low risk: checklist signed by supervisor, submitted with proposal

Medium risk: ethics form signed off by module leader

High risk: full ethics committee review required

High risk includes:

- Clinical trials or sensitive medical data
 - Participants who cannot give informed consent
 - Systems processing personal data
 - Covert observation
 - Financial inducements
-
- Most game projects are low or medium risk — but check early

Academic Integrity



Correctly and fully
referenced



Produced by you, and
only you



Plagiarism



Collusion



Commissioning



Original and unique



Honest and
trustworthy



Duplication



Misrepresentation

Use of AI Tools

Transparency

Disclose all AI use in your process documentation and reflective video — which tools, for what purpose, at what stage.

Purposeful application

AI use must be a considered methodological choice. You are responsible for all work submitted. Where AI generated content forms part of your artefact, you must demonstrate critical judgement over it.

Critical reflection

Engage analytically with what AI use meant for your practice. What did it enable? What did it foreclose? How did it shape your decisions?

Undisclosed AI use — regardless of extent — is a breach of the Academic Integrity Policy.

UNIVERSITY OF
SHEFFIELD



AI Use — A Spectrum

AI as incidental tool

Copilot for boilerplate, grammar checking, image reference generation

Have you disclosed it?

AI as significant contributor

Substantial generated content, LLM-drafted text components, AI-assisted design systems

Have you disclosed it, and can you articulate your own contribution?

AI as medium or subject of the work

A generative system, a trained model, an AI-assisted creative pipeline as the artefact itself

The question flips: not whether AI use is permitted, but how your authorial and intellectual contribution is established.

Getting

Started

Grades and Pass Mark

Distinction 70–100%	Merit 60–69%	Pass 50–59%	Near Pass / Fail Below 50%
--	-----------------------------------	----------------------------------	---

Minimum pass mark: 50% (Pass). Both assessments are compulsory — a non-submission on either means a fail regardless of the other grade.

Note: This is a Masters-level programme. The expectation is that most students will achieve at least a Merit if they engage seriously with the work.

The Scale of This

600 hours of notional learning time

That is approximately 40 hours per week for 15 weeks

- Procrastination is the primary failure mode — chip away at the work every day
- Your artefact should be approaching completion by week 10
- Use Gantt charts, burn-down charts, critical path analysis — and actually look at them
- ASK team support is available: ask.fxplus.ac.uk

Where to Get Help

Your supervisor

First point of contact for everything about your project

Via timetabled supervision sessions

Module leader

Module-level queries, escalations, anything unresolved with supervisor

william.huber@falmouth.ac.uk

ASK Team

Academic writing, study skills, time management, mental health referrals

ask.fxplus.ac.uk

Learning Space

Brief, assessment information, submission portal

Your GAM708 course page

This afternoon (13:00–16:00): LEC 1 — finding your project and entering the discourse